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Hackathon Brief: Build a Game for a Real Dealership

Theme

Design a game that motivates people at a car dealership to perform better at their jobs using real dealership activity data.

In other words, we want people to awaken their competitive spirit in a good way to improve performance.

Problem Statement

You are given real dealership event data capturing user actions across departments such as Sales, Retail Finance, Accessories, Allied Business, HR, Accounts, and Customer Care.

Your task is to design a game that motivates individuals and teams to improve performance, collaborate across departments, and move enquiries to bookings and finally to new car delivery faster through the lifecycle.

Key Message

Design a game that people will actually want to play while doing their job.

If your game rewards the wrong behavior, it will fail.

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Dataset Description

The dataset represents real dealership activity logs.

Core fields include:
- USER
- DEPARTMENT
- ACTION (2000+ types)
- BOOKING (location_code + enquiry_number)
- TIME
- LOCATION

This is real-world noisy data with high granularity.

Challenge Guidelines

- Not all actions are equal (for more info see the section below)
- Identify meaningful actions vs noise
- Focus on real business impact
- Encourage collaboration across departments
- Ensure your system cannot be easily gamed

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Not All Actions Are Equal

In real systems, many actions look similar, but they do **very different things**.

Some actions:

- move the booking forward ✅
- create real business impact ✅

Others:

- only update data ❌
- can be repeated easily ❌

Your job is to identify the difference.

Example 1 — Update vs Progress

FINANCE_INFO_UPDATED

FINANCE_APPROVED

- `FINANCE_INFO_UPDATED` → user edited data → **no real progress**
- `FINANCE_APPROVED` → booking moves forward → **high value**

Only one of these should be rewarded.

Example 2 — Repeated vs One-Time Actions

BOOKING_NOTE_ADDED

INVOICE_APPROVED

- `BOOKING_NOTE_ADDED` → can be done multiple times → **easy to game**
- `INVOICE_APPROVED` → happens once → **critical milestone**

Frequent actions need limits or low points.

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Example 3 — Granular vs Meaningful

DOCUMENTS_AADHAAR_FRONT

DOCUMENTS_AADHAAR_BACK

DOCUMENTS_VIN

These are individual document uploads.

But the real milestone is:

DOCUMENT_SET_COMPLETED

Gamify the completion, not the individual pieces.

Example 4 — Effort vs Outcome

DSE_COMMITMENTS_UPDATED

DELIVERED

- updating commitments = effort
- delivering vehicle = outcome

Outcomes should carry much higher weight.

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Example 5 — Internal vs Customer Impact

PDI_INFO_UPDATED

DELIVERED

- PDI update → internal step
- delivery → customer-facing success

Customer impact actions are more valuable.

Example 6 — Easy vs Hard Actions

USER_LOGGED_IN

BOOKING_CREATED

- login → trivial
- booking created → real business event

Easy actions should not dominate scoring

> **Reward actions that move the booking forward, not actions that simply modify the system.**

> **“If users repeat an action 50 times a day, should they get 50x points?”**
>
> **If the answer is yes, the system is broken.**

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Deliverables

1. Game Design (rules, mechanics, gameplay loop)
2. Action Mapping (which actions drive your game)
3. Anti-Gaming Strategy
4. Demo or walkthrough

Constraints

- Maximum 20 actions can be used for scoring
- Must map to real dealership workflow
- Must be sustainable for long-term use

Judging Criteria

- Game Design Quality (30%)
- Real-world relevance (25%)
- Anti-gaming robustness (20%)
- Team collaboration design (15%)
- Creativity (10%)

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Sample Scenarios

Scenario 1: Cross-Department Booking Race

A booking moves through stages such as booking creation, discount approval, finance, invoice approval, registration, PDI, and delivery. Teams design a game where each booking is like a race car on a track. Different departments help move it forward. The faster and cleaner the movement, the higher the team score.

Scenario 2: Branch vs Branch League

Each dealership location competes in a weekly or monthly league. Branches earn points for meaningful milestones such as bookings converted, invoices approved, or vehicles delivered. Penalties may apply for cancellations, excessive delays, or rework-heavy processes.

Scenario 3: Quest-Based Sales Journey

Individual salespeople earn progress through quests such as completing follow-ups, moving bookings to finance, getting documentation complete, and finally reaching delivery. Bonus quests can be designed around teamwork, such as helping finance clear bottlenecks.

Scenario 4: Boss Battle / Milestone Challenge

Departments face weekly milestone challenges. For example, the team may need to push 25 bookings through invoice approval or complete 15 deliveries without escalations. The challenge is framed as defeating a “boss”, where delays, rework, and missing documentation act as obstacles.

Scenario 5: Reputation and Role Progression Game

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Players level up not just by revenue, but by good behavior. For instance, a sales executive may earn a reputation for maintaining clean bookings, quick follow-ups, and successful closures. Finance and accounts users can similarly gain progression based on approvals, clean processing, and cooperation.

Participant Guide

Step 1: Understand the lifecycle
Do not start by assigning points immediately. First understand how a booking moves through the dealership. Identify the main stages and the departments involved.

Step 2: Separate signal from noise
The dataset contains many granular actions. Some represent real progress, while others are mere updates or edits. The first job is to decide which actions matter.

Step 3: Pick a small number of important actions
Teams may use only a maximum of 20 actions for scoring. Strong teams will avoid rewarding every event and will focus on meaningful milestones.

Step 4: Design the game loop
Ask: what does a player do, what do they earn, why do they continue, and how does the game stay fun over time? A strong submission will have a clear loop, not just a point table.

Step 5: Think beyond individuals
Dealership work is cross-functional. Think about whether the game should reward only individuals or also departments, locations, or mixed teams.

Step 6: Prevent abuse
Every good game can be exploited if designed poorly. Ask what would happen if users clicked repeatedly, updated the same booking many times, or performed low-value actions purely to earn points. The design should actively prevent this.

Step 7: Keep it practical

The design should be realistic enough to run in a live dealership for months, not just look good in a presentation. Ask what would break after a few weeks and how to fix it.

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Glossary of Terms

Roles & Departments

DSE (Dealer Sales Executive)

- Frontline salesperson
- Interacts with customers
- Creates bookings and follows up
- Drives the initial part of the sales process

Finance Team

- Handles loan processing
- Works with banks / NBFCs
- Gets loan approvals for customers

Accounts Team

- Handles internal financial transactions
- Verifies payments received
- Manages invoices, credits, debits

PDI (Pre-Delivery Inspection)

- Final vehicle inspection before delivery
- Ensures vehicle is ready for customer handover

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EDP (Electronic Data Processing / Backend Ops)

- Handles system-level processing
- Invoice creation, documentation, backend updates

CCM (Customer Care Manager)

- Handles customer communication
- Insurance coordination, approvals, follow-ups

RTO / Registration Team

- Handles vehicle registration with authorities
- Manages documentation for legal compliance

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Some Sample Actions

Action	Meaning
BOOKING_CREATED	Customer booking created
DISCOUNT_APPROVED	Pricing finalized
FINANCE_APPROVED	Loan approved
INVOICE_APPROVED	Billing completed

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RTO_REQUEST	Registration initiated
PDI_COMPLETED	Vehicle ready
DELIVERED	Vehicle handed to customer

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